

THE ABANDONED MALE CALF

A True Story of Compassion, Responsibility and Humanity

“Humanity is not simply about what we call ourselves. It is about how we treat those who cannot protect themselves.”

BE VEGAN. BE HUMAN.

The main narrative is based on the narrator’s personal account. The additional struggle cases in Section 9 are explicitly presented as possible circumstances an abandoned calf may face, not as confirmed events in this individual case.

1. THE QUESTION WE MUST ASK OURSELVES

We all call ourselves Hindus, and many of us want to make this country a Hindu nation. But before making such claims, perhaps we should ask ourselves a deeper question: why do we say these things, and are we truly living by the values we claim to believe in?

We call certain animals our mothers—for example, Gau Mata, the mother cow. Yet every day, knowingly or unknowingly, we continue to commit injustice, cruelty and exploitation against the very animal whom we call our mother.

Sometimes poverty is given as an excuse. Sometimes financial hardship is used as an excuse. Sometimes we hide behind a business model. Repeated behaviour can eventually make cruelty feel normal.

We may say that our ancestors did these things for generations and therefore they must still be acceptable. But tradition alone cannot determine morality. We must still ask whether an action is compassionate, responsible and just.

2. WHEN AN ANIMAL BECOMES ONLY A BUSINESS

We pass our thinking to the next generation. We tell children to do business, to start dairy farms, and we speak about the profit that can be made. But what happens when an animal is treated only as an economic asset?

A particularly painful example is the male calf. Because he does not produce milk, he may be considered useless or financially burdensome. A poor family may think, “We cannot afford to raise him. Let us leave him somewhere else.”

But abandonment does not solve the problem. It transfers the suffering to the street.

If we truly believe in animal protection, we need responsible ownership, effective veterinary services, adequate shelters, strong action against illegal trafficking and a system through which citizens can report suspected cruelty or trafficking.

3. THE ABANDONED MALE CALF

One day, after finishing my work, I went out as usual to feed street dogs. It was summer, in 2024.

While feeding the dogs, I noticed a male calf lying on the side of the road. I did not know whether he had been involved in an accident. But he appeared to have collapsed because of illness or severe weakness.

I immediately contacted volunteers and reported the situation. Aryan, Atul, Manav, Yes Sir, Varun Sharma Sir, some of their friends, and a friend of Anant Bal, along with others, came to see the calf.

We decided to create a temporary shelter beside the road. A makeshift shed was constructed in Navada. It was small and far from ideal, but it gave the calf some protection.

4. THE FIRST DAYS OF CARE

His treatment began. We approached nearby vegetable shops and requested the shopkeepers to keep aside vegetables that would otherwise be discarded. People cooperated and gave what they could.

The calf was eating and drinking water, but there was no significant improvement.

We contacted the veterinary emergency service by calling 1962. A veterinary team examined him and said that he had become extremely weak. He was given approximately 500 ml of plasma and saline.

We continued caring for him almost like attendants: feeding him, giving medicines, monitoring him and trying to keep him comfortable. But he still could not stand.

5. MOVING HIM TO SAFER CARE

We spoke with Varun Sharma Sir about finding a gaushala. He told us to bring the calf to him first so that we could decide what to do next.

At his place, there was a weather-protected passage between two rooms. We kept the calf there. One of his volunteers also gave him time after finishing his regular work.

For the next two or three days, we visited in the morning, around midday, in the evening and at night. We fed him, gave medicines, helped him change position and lifted or adjusted him because he could not stand by himself.

Varun Sharma Sir and his wife were also concerned and tried to find a longer-term solution. He contacted a gaushala in Mokama about shifting the calf there.

6. SEVEN TO EIGHT DAYS OF SERVICE

For approximately seven or eight days, we continued this care. The calf could eat. He could pass stool and urinate. But he could not stand properly.

Gradually, he stopped eating and drinking.

After speaking with Varun Sir and the Mokama gaushala, we shifted him there. Sadly, he did not survive for long. He died.

7. THIS WAS NOT JUST ONE CALF

This is not the story of only one animal. During the time I have observed and tried to help abandoned animals, I have seen many similar situations.

Some abandoned calves die immediately in road accidents. Some become soaked during heavy rain and fall seriously ill. Some eat contaminated or unsuitable food from the streets and develop severe

digestive problems. Some struggle with serious illness for one day and die the next.

I have also seen animals die from electric shocks. Sometimes we do not notice them at night; the next morning, we find them lying dead.

I have seen calves enter fields looking for food and then be beaten with bricks or stones. Such injuries can become severe, and some animals eventually die after becoming weaker and repeatedly falling.

8. WHEN THERE IS NO SHELTER

I have personally tried to arrange treatment for one or two such animals by calling doctors and providing care at the roadside. But I do not have a proper place where all these animals can be kept.

So wherever an animal is found, we try to create a temporary arrangement and provide whatever care is possible. In one case, an animal's condition deteriorated badly after exposure to rain. Despite our efforts, it died and was later buried.

In my city, I tried to save around seven or eight calves. Only one survived. The others died.

Calves with relatively minor problems, such as a small wound on a leg, can often be saved. But very young and severely weakened calves are extremely difficult to save without proper shelter, dedicated caregivers and immediate veterinary treatment.

9. POSSIBLE STRUGGLES OF AN ABANDONED CALF ON THE STREET

The following are possible scenarios that an abandoned calf may face. They should not be read as claims that every one of these events happened to the particular calf described above.

Hunger and dehydration: A weak calf may be unable to find enough food or clean water. Severe weakness can make it increasingly difficult to stand and search for food.

Road accidents: A calf wandering beside roads may be struck by vehicles, especially at night or in areas with poor visibility.

Heat exposure: During summer, a collapsed calf can become severely dehydrated and overheated when there is no shade or water.

Rain and cold exposure: During monsoon or cold weather, prolonged exposure to rain, wind and wet ground can worsen an already weak animal's condition.

Injuries from stones or sticks: A calf entering a field or searching for food may be chased or beaten, potentially causing wounds, fractures or internal injuries.

Electric shock: Broken wires, unsafe electrical installations or exposed electrical equipment can pose a serious danger to animals wandering on roads.

Infection: Open wounds or untreated infections can become life-threatening when veterinary care is delayed.

Digestive illness: Street animals may consume spoiled food, plastic, contaminated waste or unsuitable material, potentially causing serious digestive problems.

Predation and harassment: A severely weakened calf may be unable to defend itself from aggressive dogs or other threats.

Trafficking and illegal transport: An abandoned or unprotected animal may become vulnerable to people who see an opportunity to sell or transport it for profit.

Isolation: Perhaps one of the greatest dangers is that nobody notices. A calf may lie on the roadside for hours while people pass by.

10. THE SYSTEMIC STRUGGLE

One volunteer group cannot be everywhere, twenty-four hours a day. Individual citizens cannot rescue every animal. This is why compassion also needs systems.

We need accessible veterinary emergency services, safe shelters, responsible ownership, rapid reporting mechanisms, action against illegal trafficking, humane treatment and public awareness.

Citizens should not look away when they see an animal in serious distress. At the same time, rescue work should be coordinated safely and responsibly with veterinary professionals and lawful authorities.

11. WHAT DOES OUR TREATMENT OF ANIMALS SAY ABOUT US?

These animals cannot explain their pain. They cannot ask us for help. They cannot tell us that they are hungry, frightened, sick or abandoned.

Yet we often judge their lives according to their economic value: if an animal is useful, we keep it; if it becomes inconvenient, we abandon it.

That is the question we need to ask ourselves: What does that say about us as human beings?

If we truly believe in compassion, then compassion cannot be limited to words, religion, festivals or slogans. It has to appear in our actions.

12. BE VEGAN. BE HUMAN.

I believe that the way we treat animals can reveal something important about the kind of human beings we are becoming.

Humanity is not simply about what we call ourselves. Humanity is about how we treat those who cannot protect themselves.

If we want a more compassionate society, let us begin with the beings who have no voice, no money and no power to defend themselves.

A FINAL MESSAGE

A calf lying helplessly on a roadside may look like a small problem in a very large country. But the way we respond to that small life can reveal the size of our conscience.

**Do not measure an animal's right to live only by its economic value.
If we cannot save every animal, let us at least refuse to become indifferent to their suffering.**

BE VEGAN. BE HUMAN.

A true story of one abandoned male calf—and a reflection on compassion, responsibility and the moral choices we make every day.

“Humanity is not simply about what we call ourselves.
It is about how we treat those who cannot protect themselves.”

THE ABANDONED MALE CALF

A TRUE STORY OF COMPASSION, RESPONSIBILITY & HUMANITY

This is not just the story
of one calf. It is the story of
many innocent lives that are
abandoned, neglected and left
to suffer on the streets.

**LET COMPASSION
BE OUR CULTURE.**

**BE VEGAN.
BE HUMAN.**

THE STORY

In summer 2024, I found a male
calf collapsed by the roadside.

We built a temporary shelter,
provided food, water and
medical care with the help of
volunteers.

He was treated, given plasma
and medicines, cared for day
and night for 7–8 days.

Despite our best efforts, his
condition worsened, and he
was shifted to a gaushala.

Sadly, he did not survive.



1. FOUND COLLAPSED
BESIDE THE ROAD



2. TEMPORARY SHELTER
WAS CREATED



3. FOOD, WATER &
CARE PROVIDED



4. VETERINARY TREATMENT
& MEDICINE GIVEN



5. CARED DAY & NIGHT
WITH DEDICATION



6. SHIFTED TO GAUSHALA
BUT COULD NOT SURVIVE

POSSIBLE STRUGGLES OF AN ABANDONED CALF



**HUNGER &
DEHYDRATION**
No food, no clean
water, severe
weakness.



**ROAD
ACCIDENTS**
Struck by vehicles,
especially at night.



**RAIN & COLD
EXPOSURE**
Rain, wind and
wet ground worsen
health.



**INJURIES FROM
STONES OR STICKS**
Beaten, hurt or
chased away.



ELECTRIC SHOCK
Broken wires or
unsafe electrical
installations.



**INFECTION &
ILLNESS**
Untreated wounds
and infections.



**DIGESTIVE
ILLNESS**
Spoiled food, plastic
or contaminated
waste.



**PREDATION &
HARASSMENT**
Attacks by dogs or
other threats.



**TRAFFICKING &
ILLEGAL TRANSPORT**
Vulnerable to
exploitation and
cruelty.



ISOLATION
Nobody notices.
Nobody helps.

WHAT DOES OUR TREATMENT OF ANIMALS SAY ABOUT US?



We judge their lives
by their economic
value.



They cannot speak
their pain. But they
feel everything.



Compassion is not
in words, it is in
our actions.

A CALL FOR COMPASSION & ACTION

- ✓ Provide food, water and shelter.
- ✓ Support veterinary care and emergency services.
- ✓ Report cruelty, accidents and illegal trafficking.
- ✓ Be kind. Be responsible. Be human.
- ✓ Choose Compassion. Choose Veganism.

“

A helpless life
is in our hands.
The choice we make today
will decide the kind of
society we leave behind.



EVERY LIFE MATTERS. EVERY ACT OF KINDNESS COUNTS. ♥

BE VEGAN. BE HUMAN.



LET US BUILD A COMPASSIONATE SOCIETY
WHERE NO ANIMAL IS ABANDONED, HURT OR FORGOTTEN.



IF YOU SEE AN ANIMAL IN DISTRESS,
PLEASE HELP OR CALL YOUR LOCAL HELPLINE (1962).

DO NOT MEASURE AN ANIMAL'S RIGHT TO LIVE ONLY BY ITS ECONOMIC VALUE.

THE WAY WE TREAT ANIMALS REVEALS THE SIZE OF OUR CONSCIENCE.

